PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Engineer | Azure and Hybrid Infrastructure Security Specialist

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior Cyber Security Engineer with over five years of hands-on experience securing hybrid cloud and on-premises enterprise environments across Microsoft Azure and Microsoft 365. At the University of the Arts London (UAL), I lead the security operations, threat detection and incident response function, protecting an estate of 8,000 users across a complex hybrid infrastructure spanning Microsoft Azure Active Directory (now Microsoft Entra ID), Microsoft 365, and on-premises systems. I have deep expertise in cloud security engineering, identity and access management, endpoint protection, vulnerability management and Security Information and Event Management (SIEM), and I bring a practical, risk-led approach to strengthening security posture across hybrid environments. I thrive working autonomously in a remote-first setting, delivering security improvements that have a measurable impact on the organisation's resilience and compliance.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Cloud and Hybrid Security:** Microsoft Azure security architecture and configuration, Microsoft Entra ID (Azure Active Directory), Conditional Access, Privileged Identity Management (PIM), Azure Security Centre, Microsoft Defender for Cloud
- **Microsoft 365 Security:** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender, Microsoft Defender for Office 365, Intune and Mobile Device Management (MDM)
- **SIEM and Threat Detection:** Microsoft Sentinel, Kusto Query Language (KQL), CrowdStrike Falcon Next-Generation SIEM (NG-SIEM), Splunk Security Platform Language (SPL), detection rule development and tuning aligned to MITRE ATT&CK
- **Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR):** CrowdStrike Falcon Prevent, CrowdStrike Falcon Insight, CrowdStrike Falcon Discover
- **Identity and Access Management:** Single Sign-On (SSO), Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM), role-based access control (RBAC)
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Nessus, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), AppCheck; risk-based remediation prioritisation
- **Automation and Scripting:** PowerShell scripting, Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbook development, Microsoft Intune policy automation
- **Security Frameworks:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), NIST 800-61 Incident Response, MITRE ATT&CK, ISO 27001, CIS Controls, Cyber Essentials Plus

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 - Present*

University of the Arts London (UAL)

- Lead security operations across a hybrid cloud infrastructure, managing threat detection and incident response across Microsoft Azure, Microsoft 365 and on-premises systems for an 8,000-user estate
- Architect and maintain Microsoft Sentinel SIEM environment, developing advanced KQL detection rules, analytics workbooks and automated response playbooks to detect threats across cloud and on-premises workloads
- Administer Microsoft Entra ID Conditional Access policies, enforcing MFA and eliminating legacy authentication protocols across the Microsoft 365 tenant, reducing identity-based attack surface significantly
- Oversee CrowdStrike Falcon Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) across the full estate, performing threat hunting, detection tuning and proactive investigation of suspicious endpoint behaviours
- Manage the full incident response lifecycle (identification, containment, eradication, recovery and lessons learned) in line with NIST 800-61, coordinating with Azure infrastructure and application teams
- Conduct vulnerability management using Tenable.io and Pentera BAS, managing the risk register and tracking remediation actions to closure across Azure and on-premises assets

- Develop and maintain Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbooks and PowerShell automation to accelerate response and reduce analyst workload on repetitive alert types
- Partner with infrastructure and cloud engineering teams to embed security controls into Azure deployments and Microsoft 365 configuration changes

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity *March 2022 - March 2025*

University of the Arts London (UAL)

- Performed daily alert triage, investigation and response across Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon, investigating endpoint, identity and cloud security events across the hybrid estate
- Deployed and managed Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) across 8,000 devices, configuring policies, exclusions and automated remediation actions
- Administered Microsoft Intune for Mobile Device Management (MDM) and Mobile Application Management (MAM) across iOS and Android mobile endpoints
- Supported BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) administration, enforcing least-privilege access and privileged account governance across the hybrid environment
- Assisted in achieving and maintaining Cyber Essentials Plus certification by assessing and remediating gaps across cloud, endpoint and network security controls
- Supported Check Point Harmony Firewall administration and policy reviews, alongside Mimecast email security gateway management for anti-phishing and anti-spoofing controls

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure *February 2021 - March 2022*

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS / FinTech)

- Provided security and infrastructure engineering for a cloud-first SaaS FinTech platform, maintaining endpoint security, identity controls and vulnerability scanning across the environment
- Supported ISO 27001 compliance through internal audits, risk assessments and control implementation
- Administered Azure Active Directory and on-premises Active Directory, managing group policies, access provisioning and account lifecycle processes
- Automated infrastructure and security processes using PowerShell, improving consistency and reducing operational overhead

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Architected and deployed Microsoft Sentinel SIEM for UAL's hybrid cloud estate, integrating Azure, Microsoft 365 and on-premises log sources; reduced mean time to detect (MTTD) by over 40%
- Led CrowdStrike Falcon EDR rollout across 8,000 endpoints, achieving full visibility and enabling automated threat containment across the hybrid infrastructure
- Overhauled Microsoft Entra ID Conditional Access framework, enforcing MFA for all users and eliminating legacy authentication protocols, closing a significant identity attack vector
- Built SOAR automation playbooks for phishing, credential compromise and malware response, reducing analyst response time by approximately 60% on high-frequency alert types
- Directed response to two major security incidents within the Azure and Microsoft 365 environment, containing both within four hours and preventing further lateral movement
- Achieved Cyber Essentials Plus certification for UAL, remediating all identified gaps across cloud, endpoint and network security within agreed timescales

EDUCATION

- **M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering**
- **B.Sc. Chemical Engineering**

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Fully Remote (UK)